Persist Week of April 6, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, April 6th, 2026
- Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
- Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
- Thursday, April 9th, 1016
- Friday, April 10th, 2026
- Saturday, April 11th, 2026
- Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, April 6th, 2026
- Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
- Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
- Thursday, April 9th, 2026
- Friday, April 10th, 2026
- Saturday, April 11th, 2026
- Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, April 6th, 2026
- Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
- Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
- Thursday, April 9th, 2026
- Friday, April 10th, 2026
- Saturday, April 11th, 2026

- Sunday, April 12th, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, April 6th, 2026
  - Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
  - Thursday, April 9th, 2026
  - Friday, April 10th, 2026
  - Saturday, April 11th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 12th, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, April 6th, 2026
  - Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
  - Thursday, April 9th, 2026
  - Friday, April 10th, 2026
  - Saturday, April 11th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 12th, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, April 6th, 2026
  - Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
  - Thursday, April 9th, 2026
  - Friday, April 10th, 2026
  - Saturday, April 11th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 12th, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, April 6th, 2026
  - Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 8th, 2026
  - Thursday, April 9th, 2026
  - Friday, April 10th, 2026
  - Saturday, April 11th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 12th, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, April 6th, 2026
  - Tuesday, April 7th, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Thursday, April 9th, 2026
Friday, April 10th, 2026
Saturday, April 11th, 2026
Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note
Sumo RDL Technique
The sumo RDL will look a little different for everyone, depending on hip and adductor mobility. Set your stance only as wide as feels comfortable — even slightly wider than your normal deadlift stance is enough to create a new hinge stimulus. Your feet can point straight ahead or angle slightly outward. As you hinge, focus on pushing your hips back and letting your knees move naturally. There's no need to aggressively force the knees out. Prioritize a smooth stretch through the inner thighs and hamstrings while maintaining torso control.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Sumo DB RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min)
3 sets
Low Switch Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1Tempo
rest 60 sec
Landmine Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min)
2-3 sets
Side Plank Rotations; 20-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
Bodyweight Turkish Sit Up; 10-12 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note
Dips + Deficit Pushups

Dips and deficit pushups give you one of the biggest opportunities to explore shoulder mobility in horizontal pressing. Both movements place the shoulder into deeper extension and rotation than most presses. At the bottom of each rep, move into as much stretch as you can comfortably control. Stay active in that position — don't relax into it. Maintaining tension in the stretched range creates a strong muscle-building stimulus while also improving usable flexibility. Controlled depth over rushed reps.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Low Incline DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (15 min)
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 5-7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Barbell Skullcrushers; 8 @ 31X1Tempo

directly into
Rolling Skullcrushers; 6-8 @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min)
2 sets
Dumbbell Full Raise; 6-8 reps @ 2020 Tempo
rest 15 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 15 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note
Barbell Row
This is the third week of the progression and the third barbell row variation. Each week, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences, the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Rack Carry; 30m

KB Upright Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min)
Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Single Drop Set to Failure
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. Perform the drop set immediately after you adjust the weight from your 6-rep set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min)
Barbell Bent Over Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min)
3 sets
Tripod DB Elbowing Row; 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 30m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min)
2-3 sets
Horn Grip KB Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
directly into
Horn Grip Goblet Carry; 20-30 sec

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec
Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 9th, 1016

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work :

A) Active Recovery (40 min)
40mins Total Work - Easy Effort
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
40sec Wall Sit March
40sec Elbow to Tall Plank
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
40sec Straight Leg Hip Bridge March
20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold Left
20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold Right
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-15 min):
Squat Mobility
1.Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold

8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. For the back rack reverse lunge, avoid loading it with too much weight. A moderate weight will create plenty of stimulus for the legs. When the load gets too high, the body often shifts tension into the low back, adductors, or hamstrings instead of the target muscles. Stay controlled and own each rep.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
DB Seated Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 60 sec
Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Knees Over Toes Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Lateral Banded Walk; 10-15 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note;
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Arnold Press Technique
To execute the Arnold press correctly, start by letting the elbows move away from the midline. The elbows travel from in front of the body out to the sides. Once they reach the side position, then press the weight overhead. On the way down, reverse the same path — lower to the sides first, then sweep the elbows back toward the midline. Control the motion and keep the movement smooth rather than rushing the rotation.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15sec Cardio Sprint
Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Back Supported Single Arm Arnold Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warm-up set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 Min):

2-3 sets
Dual Kettlebell Front Rack Carry; 40m
rest 15 sec
Quadruped Reverse Crawl; 10m SLOW
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Sumo RDL Technique
The sumo RDL will look a little different for everyone, depending on hip and adductor mobility. Set your stance only as wide as feels comfortable — even slightly wider than your normal deadlift stance is enough to create a new hinge stimulus. Your feet can point straight ahead or angle slightly outward. As you hinge, focus on pushing your hips back and letting your knees move naturally. There's no need to aggressively force the knees out. Prioritize a smooth stretch through the inner thighs and hamstrings while maintaining torso control.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Sumo DB RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets

Low Switch Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Landmine Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Side Plank Rotations; 20-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
Bodyweight Turkish Sit Up; 10-12 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Barbell Row
This is the third week of the progression and the third barbell row variation. Each week, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences, the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint

BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Barbell Bent Over Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 5-7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Barbell Skullcrushers; 8 @ 31X1Tempo
Rolling Skullcrushers; 6-8 @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Horn Grip KB Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
Horn Grip Goblet Carry; 20-30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec
Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. For the back rack reverse lunge, avoid loading it with too much weight. A moderate weight will create plenty of stimulus for the legs. When the load gets too high, the body often shifts tension into the low back, adductors, or hamstrings instead of the target muscles. Stay controlled and own each rep.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
DB Seated Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):
3 sets
Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 60 sec
Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Knees Over Toes Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec
Lateral Banded Walk; 10-15 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note;
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Bench Press Progression
This training block uses three bench press angles across the progression. Week 1 is a traditional incline bench (about 30–45 degrees), Week 2 moves to a low incline (about 10–30 degrees), and Week 3 is a flat bench press. As the incline decreases, you should be able to handle more weight. Expect the load to gradually increase as the pressing angle becomes more favorable.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15sec Cardio Sprint
Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - 6 @20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Single Drop Set to Failure

Loading Note:

If using Pull Ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. Perform the drop set immediately after you adjust the weight from your 6-rep set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Tripod DB Elbowing Row; 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 30m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2 sets
Dumbbell Full Raise; 6-8 reps @ 2020 Tempo
rest 15 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 15 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
Right Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Right Arm Snatch x 6
Right Arm Press x 6
Left Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Left Arm Snatch x 6
Left Arm Press x 6
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
4 Candlestick Roll-Ups
10 Lateral Bench Hops hands-on Bench
16 Downward Dog Shoulder Taps

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg

Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Pulldown/Pull Up Descending Rep Scheme
The descending rep scheme (12, 10, 8), paired with increasing RPE, is designed to let you add load to each set. This is straightforward with the pulldown—simply increase the weight as the reps decrease. Pull ups can be a bit different. Because they’re highly fatiguing, you may keep the same level of assistance across all sets and still reach the target RPE. Each set builds fatigue in the back and lats, making the next set feel significantly harder even without changing the assistance. Focus on matching the effort, not forcing the progression.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 6 @20X1 - RPE 9-10 + Single Drop Set to Failure
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. Perform the drop set immediately after you adjust the weight from your 6-rep set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 5-7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Barbell Skullcrushers; 8 @ 31X1Tempo

directly into
Rolling Skullcrushers; 6-8 @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Side Plank Rotations; 20-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
Bodyweight Turkish Sit Up; 10-12 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying Thoracic Sweep; 5 reps/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:

Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl
Both variations are included in this cycle to account for differences in equipment. If you have access to both, either is a good choice — they just offer different benefits. The BC gliding hamstring curl is more accessible and includes more active hip extension. The Nordic hamstring curl is a heavy challenge for the lower hamstrings but usually requires significant assistance. Choose the option that lets you maintain control and get a strong hamstring stimulus.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Barbell Bent Over Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):
3 sets
Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 60 sec
Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side

rest 90 sec

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Horn Grip KB Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
directly into
Horn Grip Goblet Carry; 20-30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec
Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Bench Press Progression
This training block uses three bench press angles across the progression. Week 1 is a traditional incline bench (about 30–45 degrees), Week 2 moves to a low incline (about 10–30 degrees), and Week 3 is a flat bench press. As the incline decreases, you should be able to handle more weight. Expect the load to gradually increase as the pressing angle becomes more favorable.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
DB Seated Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Low Switch Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec
Landmine Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Dual Kettlebell Front Rack Carry; 40m
rest 15 sec
Quadruped Reverse Crawl; 10m SLOW
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.
Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
Right Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Right Arm Snatch x 6
Right Arm Press x 6
Left Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Left Arm Snatch x 6

Left Arm Press x 6
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
4 Candlestick Roll-Ups
10 Lateral Bench Hops hands-on Bench
16 Downward Dog Shoulder Taps

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-15 min):
Squat Mobility
1.Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6.Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Monday, April 6th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Sumo RDL Technique
The sumo RDL will look a little different for everyone, depending on hip and adductor mobility. Set your stance only as wide as feels comfortable — even slightly wider than your normal deadlift stance is enough to create a new hinge stimulus. Your feet can point straight ahead or angle slightly outward. As you hinge, focus on pushing your hips back and letting your knees move naturally. There's no need to aggressively force the knees out. Prioritize a smooth stretch through the inner thighs and hamstrings while maintaining torso control.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets

Low Switch Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Landmine Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 3:00 x 5 sets
12 DB Sumo RDL @ 20X0 TEMPO 50/35lb# (Male/Female)
12 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10lb# @ 20X0 TEMPO
Row 200/160m @ High Effort
Effort Note:
Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note: Week 3 - Dips + Deficit Pushups
Dips and deficit pushups give you one of the biggest opportunities to explore shoulder mobility in horizontal pressing. Both movements place the shoulder into deeper extension and rotation than most presses. At the bottom of each rep, move into as much stretch as you can comfortably control. Stay active in that position — don't relax into it. Maintaining tension in the stretched range creates a strong muscle-building stimulus while also improving usable flexibility. Controlled depth over rushed reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 5-7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Barbell Skullcrushers; 8 @ 31X1 Tempo
directly into
Rolling Skullcrushers; 6-8 @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):
6min As Many Reps As Possible
500/400m Row Buy In (Male/Female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....
Low Incline DB Bench Press 50/35#
*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP (As Many Reps As Possible)
Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps
Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Barbell Row
This is the third week of the progression and the third barbell row variation. Each week, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences, the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Rack Carry; 30m
KB Upright Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 6 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9-10 + Single Drop Set to Failure
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the drop set, don't worry about

percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. Perform the drop set immediately after you adjust the weight from your 6-rep set.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 Min):
3 sets:
Wide Grip Barbell Row; 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 30m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) High Turnover Cardio (14 min):
Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets
12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)
6 Chainsaw Row Right Arm 70/50#
6 Chainsaw Row Left Arm 70/50#
Rest 2 minutes
Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets
12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)
3 Single Arm DB Burpee Right Arm 70/50#
3 Single Arm DB Burpee Left Arm 70/50#
Effort Note:
Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set. Take 2 minutes' rest after your first 3 sets. Push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec
Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery (40 min)

40mins Total Work - Easy Effort
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
40sec Wall Sit March
40sec Elbow to Tall Plank
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
40sec Straight Leg Hip Bridge March
20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold Left
20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold Right
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-15 min):
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side
Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Friday, April 10th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. For the back rack reverse lunge, avoid loading it with too much weight. A moderate weight will create plenty of stimulus for the legs. When the load gets too high, the body often shifts tension into the low back, adductors, or hamstrings instead of the target muscles. Stay controlled and own each rep.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min): 3 sets
Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):
3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible
600/450m Bike (Male/Female)
12 Alternating Goblet Low Box Step Up 53/35# or 35/26# 20/16" (6/leg)
6 Right Arm Single Arm KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
6 Left Arm Single Arm KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
in remaining time:
KB Russian Twists 53/35# or 35/26#
rest 2 mins between sets
Effort Note:

For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform bike, step-ups, and KB rack squats. In the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of KB Russian Twists. When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
More Upper Back
The upper back handles fatigue well, which means it can be trained frequently throughout the week. In the strength balance section, you'll see additional rowing variations for that reason. Beyond building strength, consistent upper back work also helps support balance around the shoulder and improves overall pressing mechanics.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15sec Cardio Sprint
Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min): Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2min x 6 sets
4-8 Pronated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo
8-12 KB Push Press 53/35# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.
And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Sumo RDL Technique
The sumo RDL will look a little different for everyone, depending on hip and adductor mobility. Set your stance only as wide as feels comfortable — even slightly wider than your normal deadlift stance is enough to create a new hinge stimulus. Your feet can point straight ahead or angle slightly outward. As you hinge, focus on pushing your hips back and letting your knees move naturally. There's no need to aggressively force the knees out. Prioritize a smooth stretch through the inner thighs and hamstrings while maintaining torso control.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
:
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Low Switch Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Landmine Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 3:00 x 5 sets
12 DB Sumo RDL @ 20X0 TEMPO 50/35# (Male/Female)
12 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10# @ 20X0 TEMPO
Row 200/160m @ High Effort
Effort Note:
Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Barbell Row
This is the third week of the progression and the third barbell row variation. Each week, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences,

the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 6 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9-10 + Single Drop Set to Failure
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. Perform the drop set immediately after you adjust the weight from your 6-rep set.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets:
Wide Grip Barbell Row; 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 30m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):
6min As Many Reps As Possible
500/400m Row Buy In (Male/Female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....
Low Incline DB Bench Press 50/35#
*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP (As Many Reps As Possible)
Effort Note:
Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-15 min):
Squat Mobility
1.Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2.Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Back Rack Reverse Lunge
Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. For the back rack reverse lunge, avoid loading it with too much weight. A moderate weight will create plenty of stimulus for the legs. When the load gets too high, the body often shifts tension into the low back, adductors, or hamstrings instead of the target muscles. Stay controlled and own each rep.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):
3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible
600/450m Bike (Male/Female)
12 Alternating Goblet Low Box Step Up 53/35# or 35/26# 20/16" (6/leg)
6 Right Arm Single Arm KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
6 Left Arm Single Arm KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
in remaining time:
KB Russian Twists 53/35# or 35/26#
rest 2 mins between sets
Effort Note:
For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform bike, step-ups, and KB rack squats. In the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of KB Russian Twists. When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
More Upper Back
The upper back handles fatigue well, which means it can be trained frequently throughout the week. In the strength balance section, you'll see additional rowing variations for that reason. Beyond building strength, consistent upper back work also helps support balance around the shoulder and improves overall pressing mechanics.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15sec Cardio Sprint
Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps

Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2min x 6 sets
4-8 Pronated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo
8-12 KB Push Press 53/35# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull-Ups - Scale your pull-ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.
*Shutte Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
Right Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Right Arm Snatch x 6
Right Arm Press x 6
Left Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Left Arm Snatch x 6
Left Arm Press x 6
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
4 Candlestick Roll-Ups
10 Lateral Bench Hops hands-on Bench
16 Downward Dog Shoulder Taps

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):
Squat Mobility
1.Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Dips + Deficit Pushups
Dips and deficit pushups give you one of the biggest opportunities to explore shoulder mobility in horizontal pressing. Both movements place the shoulder into deeper extension and rotation than most presses. At the bottom of each rep, move into as much stretch as you can comfortably control. Stay active in that position — don’t relax into it. Maintaining tension in the stretched range creates a strong muscle-building stimulus while also improving usable flexibility. Controlled depth over rushed reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 5-7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Barbell Skullcrushers; 8 reps @ 31X1 Tempo
directly into
Rolling Skullcrushers; 6-8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 3:00 x 5 sets
12 DB Sumo RDL @ 20X0 TEMPO 50/35# (Male/Female)
12 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10# @ 20X0 TEMPO
Row 200/160m @ High Effort
Effort Note:
Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Sidelying Thoracic Sweep; 5 reps/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Barbell Row
This is the third week of the progression and the third barbell row variation. Each week, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences, the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side

Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets:
Wide Grip Barbell Row; 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 30m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):
3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible
600/450m Bike (Male/Female)
12 Alternating Goblet Low Box Step Up 53/35# or 35/26# 20/16" (6/leg)
6 Right Arm Single Arm KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
6 Left Arm Single Arm KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
in remaining time:
KB Russian Twists 53/35# or 35/26#
rest 2 mins between sets
Effort Note:
For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform bike, step-ups, and KB rack squats. In the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of KB Russian Twists. When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec
Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min) :
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Landmine Meadow Row Technique
The landmine meadows row is a single-arm row variation that uses the landmine setup to challenge the upper back, lats, and rear delts from a different angle.
Use a wider elbow path and focus on pulling through the back rather than the arm. The leverage of the landmine helps create a strong contraction while keeping tension consistent throughout the rep.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):
6min As Many Reps As Possible
500/400m Row Buy In (Male/Female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....
Low Incline DB Bench Press 50/35#
*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP (As Many Reps As Possible)
Effort Note:
Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30-35 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
Right Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Right Arm Snatch x 6
Right Arm Press x 6
Left Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Left Arm Snatch x 6
Left Arm Press x 6
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
4 Candlestick Roll-Ups
10 Lateral Bench Hops hands-on Bench
16 Downward Dog Shoulder Taps

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-15 min)
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Continuous Vertical Jump
One of the most overlooked areas of training is the ability to produce a lot of force in a short amount of time. This quality shows up in sprinting, repetitive jumping, and countless real-world movements.
During the continuous vertical jumps today, focus on minimizing your ground contact time. Get on and off the floor as quickly as you can between reps. The goal isn't just to jump high — it's to be fast and reactive with each takeoff. Think of the ground as hot and your job is to spend as little time on it as possible.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+

3 Sets
1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2) Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
3) Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
4-5 sets; rest 90-120sec between sets
1 Hang Power Clean + 5 Continuous Vertical Jump
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging
*Aim for max power/height on every jump.

D) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Low Switch Landmine Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Landmine Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Interval Weight Training (15 min):
3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)
300/240m Row (Male/Female)
12 Dual KB Rack Squat 53/35# or 35/26#
12 Dual KB Rack Walking Lunge 53/35# or 35/26#
- in remaining time:
KB Plank Knee to Elbows
- rest 2mins between sets

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Dips + Deficit Pushups
Dips and deficit pushups give you one of the biggest opportunities to explore shoulder mobility in horizontal pressing. Both movements place the shoulder into deeper extension and rotation than most presses. At the bottom of each rep, move into as much stretch as you can comfortably control. Stay active in that position — don't relax into it. Maintaining tension in the stretched range creates a strong muscle-building stimulus while also improving usable flexibility. Controlled depth over rushed reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2) Bodyweight Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3) Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Engine Hot Start (10 min):
Every 2:30 x 3-4 Sets at Increasing Pace
30sec Single Leg Tuck L-Sit
Bike 600/480m (Male/Female)
rest remaining time
Effort Note
Set 1 - Easy to Moderate
Set 2 - Moderate
Set 3 - Moderate to Hard
Set 4 - Hard

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Strict Bar Dip; 5-7 reps @ 22X1 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrushers; 8 @ 31X1 Tempo
- directly into
3. Rolling Skullcrushers; 6-8 @ 20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Upper Couplets (14 min):
6min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)
500/400m Row Buy In (Male/Female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....

Low Incline DB Bench Press 50/35#
*20 Double Unders or 30 Single Unders between each round
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Complete the Buy In on the cardio machine before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2) Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Barbell Row
This is the third week of the progression and the third barbell row variation. Each week, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences, the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2) Dual DB Rack Carry; 30m
3) KB Upright Row; 10-12 reps

C) Kettlebell Hot Start (10 min):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
15/12 Calorie Row (Male/Female)
5 KB Rotational Snatch Right 53/35#
5 KB Windmill 53/35#
5 KB Rotational Snatch Left 53/35#
5 KB Windmill 53/35#

rest 45 sec between rounds
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 6 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9-10 + Single Drop Set to Failure
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For the drop set, don't worry about percentages; instead, add back two levels of assistance (or less weight), similar to your first and second working sets. Perform the drop set immediately after you adjust the weight from your 6-rep set.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets:
1. Wide Grip Barbell Row; 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Farmers Walk; 30m
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Aerobic Carry (16 min):
16min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @ 75-80%
8 DB Burpee Box Step Up
12 Straight Leg Sit Up
50 Feet Single Arm KB Rack Carry R
50 Feet Single Arm KB Rack Carry L
Effort Note:

Perform as many rounds and reps as possible in 16 minutes. Start at a sustainable pace and gradually build momentum if you are feeling good. Aim for the row pace to be consistent from the start to the end.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Bottom of Dip Stretch; 30 sec
2) Weighted Straddle Stretch; 30 sec
3) Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40mins Total Work - Easy Effort
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
- 40sec Wall Sit March
- 40sec E#ow to Tall Plank
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, 15, and 20 stop and perform
- 40sec Straight Leg Hip Bridge March
- 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold L
- 20sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold R
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-15 min):
Squat Mobility
1. Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side

10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Single Leg Strength
Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. Single leg exercises are great variations to include in conditioning because of their low-skill-nature. In order to get the most out of these movements, it is important that you maintain tension around the core.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
2) Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Full Snatch + 1 Snatch Balance + 1 Overhead Squat
- rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side
- rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Threshold Lower Body (15 min):
3 Sets
Bike 600 (Male/Female)
8 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand 53/35
8 Goblet Squat 53/35
rest 30sec
20 Jump Lunges (10/side)
15 American Kettlebell Swings 53/35
10 Alternating Pistols (simplify - Goblet Kickstand Pistol Squat x 5/leg) 53/35
Bike 600m
rest 60sec

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
More Upper Back
The upper back handles fatigue well, which means it can be trained frequently throughout the week. In the strength balance section, you'll see additional rowing variations for that reason. Beyond building strength, consistent upper back work also helps support balance around the shoulder and improves overall pressing mechanics.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) 15sec Cardio Sprint
2) Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
3) Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
4) Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Gymnastics Skills (10 min):
4 sets each; rest as needed
1. 2-3 Strict Ring Muscle Up
2. 30sec Weighted Hollow Rock or Hollow Body Hold
Effort Note:
Any muscle up variation is acceptable in place of the strict ring muscle up. A regression may be the following:
Strict Ring Muscle Up > Muscle Up > Bar Muscle Up > Band Assisted Muscle Up > Muscle Up Ring Row + Ring Dip

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets
1. Landmine Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2min x 6 sets
4-8 Pronated Strict Pull Up @ 30X0 Tempo
8-12 KB Push Press 53/35# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2) PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3) Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations — everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build — not just to shrink.

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, April 6th, 2026

Week 3 Day 1 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
Sumo RDL Technique
The sumo RDL will look a little different for everyone, depending on hip and adductor mobility. Set your stance only as wide as feels comfortable — even slightly wider than your normal deadlift stance is enough to create a new hinge stimulus. Your feet can point straight ahead or angle slightly outward. As you hinge, focus on pushing your hips back and letting your knees move naturally. There's no need to aggressively force the knees out. Prioritize a smooth stretch through the inner thighs and hamstrings while maintaining torso control.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2) Goblet Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
3) Shinbox Hip Extension + Switch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
DB Suitcase Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ Set 1 weight @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Low Switch Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side @ 31X1 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Goblet Kickstand Squat; 8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 3:00 x 5 sets
12 DB Sumo RDL @ 20X0 Tempo 50/35# (Male/Female)
12 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Ups 25/10# @ 20X0 Tempo
6 Shuttle Run (down+back=1)
Effort Note:
Every 3 minutes, begin a new set. Complete all three movements in the listed order within the 3-minute window. This is performed as a sequence, not separate intervals. Aim to finish the work with approximately 30 seconds remaining in each 3-minute block so you can rest before the next set begins. Adjust your pace as needed to maintain consistent effort across all 5 sets.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, April 7th, 2026

Week 3 Day 2 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
DB Row
In this training block we are using incline prone and bent over dumbbell rows. These exercises are similar, but dependent on your strengths and weaknesses, you may not be able to perform the same weight. When performing the bent over dumbbell row, make sure you are maintaing the low back in a great position.

Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2) BW Side Plank Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
3) Slow Shoulder Circles; 5/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Dumbbell Alternating Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets:
1. Incline Prone Dumbbell Row; 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Farmers Walk; 30m
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):
6min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)
400m Run
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....
Low Incline DB Bench Press 50/35#
*4 Burpees between each round
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:

Complete the Buy In Run before moving on to the ascending couplet. In the remaining time of the AMRAP (after the Buy In), go as far as you can in the couplet. Take a 2-minute rest, then repeat the same AMRAP.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2) Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, April 8th, 2026

Week 3 Day 3 - Persist Minimalist

A) Active Recovery Work: Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
1. Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Thursday, April 9th, 2026

Week 3 Day 4 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note: Single Leg Strength
Single-leg strength is a staple in Persist for a reason. These movements build leg strength and coordination while also challenging the smaller stabilizing muscles around the hips. Single leg exercises are great variations to include in conditioning because of their low-skill-nature. In order to get the most out of these movements, it is important that you maintain tension around the core.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Front Foot Elevated KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
2) Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Bent Hollow Body Hold; 15 sec/side
- rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (14 min):
3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)
12 Alternating Goblet Low Box Step Up 53/35# or 35/25# 20/16" (6/leg) (Male/Female)
6 Right Arm Single Arm DB Front Squat 50/35# or 35/25#
6 Left Arm Single Arm DB Front Squat 50/35# or 35/25#
24 Air Squat
- in remaining time:
KB Russian Twists 35/25#
- rest 2 mins between sets
Effort Note:

For each set, set a timer for 3 minutes. During those 3 minutes, perform the step up and squats then, in the remaining time, complete as many reps as possible of the Russian Twists. When the 3-minute timer ends, rest for 2 minutes, then return to the beginning for set 2. Perform 3 total sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, April 10th, 2026

Week 3 Day 5 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
More Upper Back
The upper back handles fatigue well, which means it can be trained frequently throughout the week. In the strength balance section, you'll see additional rowing variations for that reason. Beyond building strength, consistent upper back work also helps support balance around the shoulder and improves overall pressing mechanics.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) 15sec Cardio Sprint
2) Single Arm Plank; 10-20 sec/side
3) Prone Snow Angels; 10 reps
4) Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Dumbbell Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Dumbbell Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Full Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2min x 6 sets
4-8 Pronated Strict Pullup @ 30X0 Tempo
8-12 DB Push Press 50/35# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
100m Run or 5 Shuttle Runs
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull-Ups - Scale your pull-ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2) PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3) Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 11th, 2026

Week 3 Day 6 - Persist Minimalist

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec

x6
2 Sets
Right Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Right Arm Snatch x 6
Right Arm Press x 6
Left Arm Snatch High Pull x 6
Left Arm Snatch x 6
Left Arm Press x 6
Run/Bike/Row 60sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x6
2 Sets
4 Candlestick Roll-Ups
10 Lateral Bench Hops hands-on Bench
16 Downward Dog Shoulder Taps

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
1. Shinbox Switch x 10/side
2. Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5/side
3. Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch
4. Downdog Calf Stretch x 10/leg
5. Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
7. Active Hip Flexion x 5/side with 5 sec hold
8. Russian Babymaker x 10
9. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5/side
10. Squat Hip Rotations x 10/side

Sunday, April 12th, 2026

Week 3 Day 7 - Persist Minimalist

Work in Lesson - Week 3

Body fat percentage dominates fitness conversations - everyone seems to have a goal body fat percentage. But just because you are lean doesn't mean you have a lot of muscle mass.

And lean mass is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health. Muscle protects your joints, supports your metabolism, improves insulin sensitivity, and gives you the strength reserve you'll

rely on as you age. If your only goal is "get leaner," you'll eventually underfuel, under-recover, and give up strength you can't afford to lose.

Instead of asking, "How lean can I get?" Ask, "How strong and capable can I become?" Train to build - not just to shrink.

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Marcus